

AC Template Card

Day 2 · Activity 2 handout. The pocket card for drafting one Acceptance Criterion. One Given/When/Then per AC, no ANDs in the Then that represent separate behaviors. Copy the block per AC into PRD Section 6.

The shape

```
Given <a precondition / starting state>
When  <a single action or event>
Then  <one observable, falsifiable result>
```

The rules

- **One behavior per AC.** If your Then has ANDs that describe *different system actions*, split into multiple AC. (ANDs that describe one observable state are OK — that's a judgment call.)
 - **Name the exact** system state, screen, or event — no "the dashboard", say *which* screen and *what* it shows.
 - **A junior engineer** should be able to read it and write a passing/failing test without asking you a question.
 - **No implementation.** Describe behavior, not caches, queues, or frameworks.
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Worked FieldPulse example (happy path)

```
Given a dispatcher viewing the end-of-shift summary
When they tap "Reconcile all"
Then the reconcile modal opens within 1 second
    and shows all open tickets pre-selected
    and the header shows the count of tickets selected
```

(The "and"s here are parts of one observable state, not separate behaviors — so this stays one AC.)

Blank cards to fill

Given
When
Then

Given
When
Then

Given
When
Then

Run each finished AC through the **5-failure-mode check** (Vague / Untestable / Restating the goal / AND-soup / Implementation-prescriptive) before appending to Section 6.